that pass these checks are then forwarded on to the services within the network. Because the ingress controller itself runs within the network, it can be included in the Linkerd service mesh, ensuring that the forwarded requests are automatically upgraded to HTTPS.

> DEFINITION A Kubernetes ***ingress controller*** is a reverse proxy or load balancer that handles requests coming into the network from external clients. An ingress controller also often functions as an API gateway, providing a unified API for multiple services within the cluster.

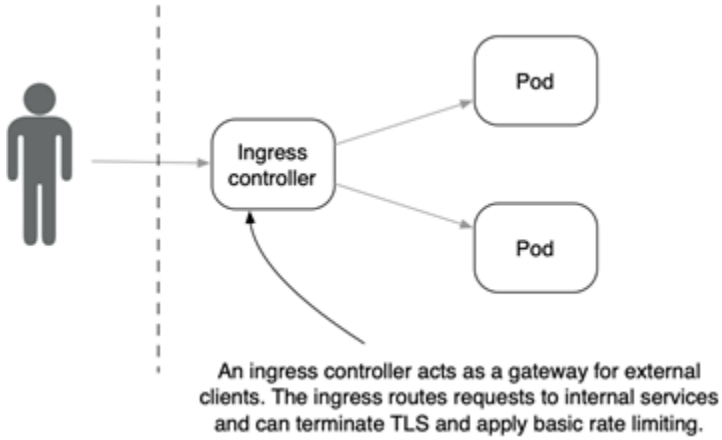


Figure 10.7 An ingress controller acts as a gateway for all requests from external clients. The ingress can perform tasks of a reverse proxy or load balancer, such as terminating TLS connections, performing rate-limiting, and audit logging.

> NOTE An ingress controller usually handles incoming requests for an entire Kubernetes cluster. Enabling or disabling an ingress controller may therefore have